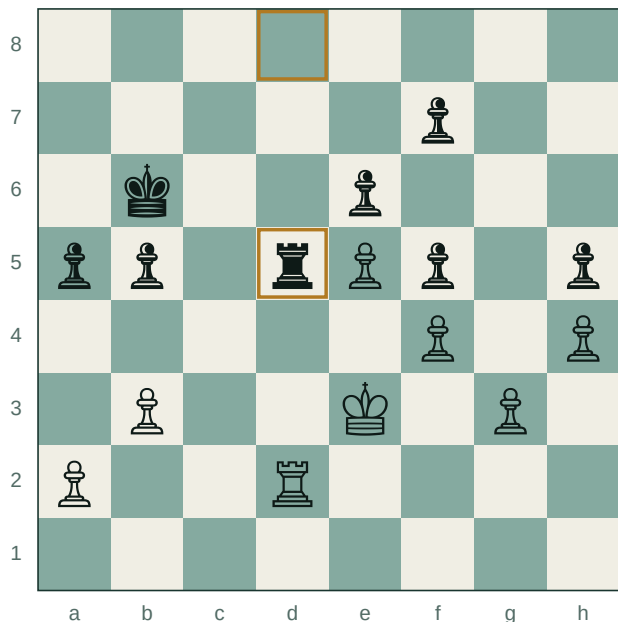


Active defensive resources: White, move 33

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 32...Rxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rxd5 exd5 34. Kd4 Kc6 35. a3

33.Rxd5 The rook captures the rook on d5. Recorded reply: **33...exd5**.

34.Kd4 The king moves from e3 to d4. Recorded reply: **34...Kc6**.

35.a3 The pawn moves from a2 to a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.